



3rd Grade Strive Academy Blueprint

Explorer Cadet | Adaptive Learning Protocol Conversion

This document converts the source grade curriculum into a Strive Academy operating blueprint: integrated missions, 4MAT learning, retrieval practice, variable learning modes, mastery checks, and Mind Palace reflection.

Core Operating Idea	Students do not just finish assignments. They prove mastery, reflect, improve, and apply knowledge in real life.
Grade Role	Explorer Cadet
Primary Use	Teacher planning, parent transparency, AI lesson generation, weekly mission mapping, and student support.

1. Source Curriculum Snapshot

Source file: 3rd-Grade-Curriculum-Transparency-2025-24.pdf

Core Knowledge grade 3, Shurley grammar level 3, world rivers, earliest Americans, Vikings, exploration of North America, thirteen colonies, ancient Rome, rich mythology and literature, homeroom novels, poetry, ReadWorks literary analysis, science body/senses/astronomy/force/weather, Adventures in Language writing, math units, intensive reading/math/spelling options.

Strive does not throw away the curriculum. It turns it into a better delivery system. Same academic spine; stronger mission framing, mastery feedback, project application, and reflection.

Core Subject Translation

Strive Module	Source Curriculum Content / Grade Focus
Reading Quest	Alice, mythology, colonial stories, homeroom novels, fluency and comprehension
Word Lab	Shurley grammar, poetry, sayings, Spalding as needed
Math Arena	Number sense, addition/subtraction, multiplication/division, perimeter/area, fractions, measurement, shapes, graphs
Science Bay	Animal classification, ecology, bones/muscles, nervous system, vision/light, hearing/sound, astronomy, force/motion, weather/climate
History Expedition	World rivers, earliest Americans, Vikings, North American exploration, thirteen colonies, ancient Rome
Logic Deck	Comprehension Skills B1, literary analysis, evidence-based answers

2. Strive Protocol Applied to This Grade

Protocol	Classroom Meaning
S - Stack Functions	Connect reading, vocabulary, geography, science, writing, art, and character through one shared mission theme. Less fragmentation, more sticky learning.
T - Teach through 4MAT	Every lesson moves through WHY, WHAT, HOW, WHAT IF, then a mastery check. No random worksheet confetti.
R - Retrieval + Spacing	Daily flashback questions, speed reads, flashcards, teach-back drills, and cumulative reviews so knowledge stays loaded.
I - Integrated Learning Paths	Units become missions. Each subject studies the same world from a different lens.
V - Variable Modes	Visual, audio, kinesthetic, conversational, simplified, and challenge modes for ADHD, autism, dyslexia, and advanced learners.
E - Evaluate & Evolve	Mastery scores, reflection, and kaizen improvements decide what changes next week.

The goal is simple: every subject helps another subject. Reading strengthens science. History strengthens vocabulary. Math appears inside maps, experiments, businesses, and builds. Worksheets stop wandering around like lost cows.

3. Daily Cadence and Learning Architecture

The grade day should be run as a repeatable operating system. Kids need rhythm, not chaos wearing a cardigan.

Block	Time	Purpose	Strive Output
Launch Briefing	5 min	Mission theme, virtue, and big question	Student can say why the mission matters
Core Academic Rotations	90-120 min	Reading, math, writing, science/history, word lab	Micro-lessons with 80-90% mastery target
Retrieval Loop	10-15 min	Spaced review from yesterday, last week, and last month	Flashcards, quiz, oral recall, speed read
Applied Mission Lab	30-60 min	Hands-on project, model, map, experiment, art, debate, build	Evidence of doing, not just hearing
Mind Palace Debrief	5-10 min	Reflection, emotion, effort, courage, mistake learned	Per-lesson or daily mission report

Weekly Flow

- Monday: mission launch, vocabulary pre-load, big question, first WHY/WHAT lesson.
- Tuesday-Wednesday: deep practice, integrated reading/math/science/history tasks, retrieval from prior lessons.
- Thursday: project build, writing draft, discussion, and teach-back rehearsal.
- Friday: mastery check, mission report, portfolio artifact, and kaizen debrief.

4. Mission Report Integration

Each lesson can use the per-lesson Mission Report. Each week can use the Weekly Mission Report. This creates visible accountability without turning the child into a paperwork mule.

Report Element	What Student Answers
WHY	Why does this matter in life, family, citizenship, faith, business, or stewardship?
WHAT	What are the 3 most important ideas? Explain it in your own words.
HOW	Show the work: solve, diagram, build, read aloud, write, act, map, or teach.
WHAT IF	Where else could this be used? What happens if the idea is changed or missing?
GRIT	Best mistake, lesson learned, and one change for next time.

5. Grade Mission Map

These are not the only units. They are the first clean mission arcs to convert the grade into Strive-style integrated learning. Each arc can become a 1-4 week unit depending on depth, student pace, and family schedule.

#	Mission Arc	Best Integrated Subjects
1	World Rivers Navigation	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
2	Viking Longship Challenge	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
3	Ancient Rome Engineering	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
4	Thirteen Colonies Debate	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
5	Animal Classification Base	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
6	Bones & Muscles Mech Suit	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
7	Vision and Light Lab	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
8	Sound Signal Station	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
9	Force & Motion Rocket Test	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic
10	Weather and Climate Watch	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + Science + Logic
11	Fraction Supply Depot	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic
12	Poetry Signal Codes	Reading + Vocabulary + Writing + History/Geography + Logic

6. Sample Integrated Mission

Mission Theme: Ancient Rome Engineering

4MAT Phase	Teacher / Student Move
WHY	Why do roads, laws, and engineering still affect modern cities?
WHAT	Roman roads, aqueducts, republic ideas, myths, geography, and vocabulary.
HOW	Map Rome, build a paper aqueduct slope, read a Roman passage, and solve measurement problems.
WHAT IF	Design a Strive Academy space colony using one Roman idea but improve it.
MASTERY	Student teaches 3 Roman contributions and completes a map/model explanation.

7. Mastery, Adaptation, and Intervention Rules

Mastery target: 80-90%. Below that, reteach differently. Above that, extend. The system should adapt; the student should not be blamed for a bad lesson design. That is how you avoid educational whack-a-mole.

Signal	AI/Mentor Response
Low accuracy	Drop one difficulty level, give worked examples, then retry with fewer problems.
Slow completion	Break into smaller steps, use timers, remove visual clutter, and add oral response option.
Repeated same error	Teach the misconception directly; add contrast examples and a quick teach-back.
Low engagement	Switch modality: story, diagram, movement, debate, or build challenge.
Fast mastery	Unlock challenge path, project extension, leadership role, or teach-it drill.
Emotional frustration	Pause, name the obstacle, do one easier win, then return. Grit is trained, not yelled into existence.

Grade-Level Mastery Evidence

- Student can explain the big idea in age-appropriate words without simply copying the teacher.
- Student can complete a visible task: diagram, problem, model, oral retell, written paragraph, map, experiment, or project artifact.
- Student can retrieve prior learning after a delay, not just five seconds after being told.
- Student can identify one mistake and one improvement step.
- Student can connect the learning to real life, a story, a virtue, stewardship, citizenship, or a practical skill.

8. AI Lesson Generator Input Template

Grade: 3rd Grade

Mission theme: [choose one from Grade Mission Map]

Source content: [paste textbook/unit notes]

Target reading level: [student level]

Required outputs: WHY hook, WHAT explanation, HOW activity, WHAT IF challenge, mastery check, 10 vocabulary words, 5 retrieval questions, simplified version, challenge version, Mind Palace reflection prompt.

Student supports: ADHD-friendly chunks, dyslexia-friendly reading passage, autism-friendly clear expectations, optional oral response, visual diagram, and hands-on activity.

9. Parent / Mentor Weekly Review

Question	Answer Space
What did the student master this week?	
What needs reteaching next week?	
Which modality worked best?	Visual / Audio / Hands-on / Conversation / Reading / Mixed
What character habit improved?	
What is one kaizen change for next week?	